

How can 'success' be summarized from different outcome areas (success criteria and rubrics)?

Sometimes you want an overall summary of how 'successful' an agency, provider, policy or initiative is. In terms of the relevant DoView strategy/outcomes diagram, from a conceptual point of view, you want to combine the results from a number of different boxes within the initiative's DoView. To do this, you can develop a 'rubric'. Doing this raises the same issues as when creating an 'index' - combining several indicators (see the When an Index Can be Used Checklist (D14)). Conceptually, it is also related to target setting (see the Appropriateness of a Set of Targets Checklist (D6)). In a rubric, you are, in a sense, setting targets for the achievement of a combined set of boxes.

Rubrics are also known as 'success criteria' and 'maturity models' (showing an initiative's increasing levels of 'maturity'). As for an index, a rubric stands or falls on how credible it is in combining the criteria defining success at each level. So, for instance, if the highest level of success has five criteria, the question is whether these five criteria, when combined, give a valid overall measure of high-level success. The issue here is the same as has discussed in tools related to indicator setting within this DoView Planning: if the set of success criteria in the rubric is not a comprehensive set (see D4 and D5), or if they lie at too low a level within the initiative's strategy/outcomes diagram (see D4), then the use of the set of success criteria or rubric may be problematic. The approach also assumes that, on the criteria selected, you are able to robustly differentiate success for each of the levels that you have selected for your success criteria (typically 3, 5, or so). It may or may not be the case that this is feasible. Lastly, like all evaluation, you need to deal with the underlying issue of attribution and whether not-necessarily controllable indicators end up being unintentionally included within the set of success criteria in the rubric. This issue is discussed in the Including Impact Information in Indicator Reporting Explainer (H2).